

Committee of the Whole - Roundtables - Notes

May 27, 2020 - 4 PM - Via Zoom

Mayor - Committee of the Whole called to order at 4:01 PM - We will discuss the potential fall 2020 scenarios today in the hopes of taking a proactive approach. Roll call please

Roll Call - 7-0

Mayor - there will be (8) breakout rooms and (4) language based groups: Portuguese, Spanish, Haitian Creole and Arabic.

Dr. Edouard-Vincent -Good Afternoon everyone, I see that we have 270 participants so far - please be advised we are on a tight time schedule - There are (12) breakout groups - Please use the raise hand function - The groups are large - You can use the chat function in breakout sessions. Those will be kept as part of the notes for these sessions.

Mr. Teixeira - Director of EL - I will introduce our translators for today: Jessie Reinold-Spanish. Ghislane Pinto - Portuguese - May Abuhasan - Arabic - and Andree Pierre-Paul - Haitian Creole

Dr. Cushing - assigned everyone to groups

(*I was assigned to School Committee Member, Mea Mustone's Group)

Mayor - Welcome back. I hope everyone's session went well.

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We had nearly 300 participants - thank you to all - Each group will now quickly report out

Mayor - The messages from principals very helpful - zoom/google meets in AM very helpful - Issues: some kids don't show up to zoom & it doesn't affect grading, the computer can be hard on the eyes, and some parents do not want their children on camera, also not every child has internet access

Member McLaughlin - It was especially nice to hear about the intimacy that has happened through all this between the schools and families - students feel even more connected to their school community. Being home allows for some flexibility. Issues: consistency among schools, grades, lessons, and participation and increasing the need for regular communication necessary.

Member Kreatz - Thank you all - It was discussed that the high school has access to Plato and other platforms, which are helpful. Issues: are around consistency. Question: Would double sessions work? Issues: Are our facilities large enough for social distancing? Students wearing masks would be difficult. Masks muffle student voices. - K students need interaction, a lot of hands on, so what would we do? Will students get to play sports? And will we have an after school program? Needed for working parents.

Member Van der Kloot - Parents discussed how difficult this situation has been for them, trying to work at home and assist their children with lessons at same time. It broke my heart. A teacher found a talking points program that provides 30 different translations, so that helped with her students. Parents of IEP students were very grateful for the amount of communication, our staff is terrific - Parents indicated that some teachers had incredible amounts of work. Devices are needed. MHS submaster, a plus that lessons are taped, for working students, as they can still pass in their work. - Anxiety on all sides including the Voke - teachers/parents/students - we are all learning how to swim everyone doing a great job

Member Ruseau - excellent conversation - PTO is being asked to pick up tab what school doesn't provide - different ways different schools fundraise, so students don't have equal access to things - computers for teachers - some teachers had to buy their own computers to teach - a number of chromebooks are freezing up - Parents need to know what is expected and how to follow through - and it can't be different for each classroom

Member Mustone - hard to hear Mea, Ms. Galusi has the notes

Ms. Galusi / Mr. Downs - difficult to keep everyone engaged - struggle for everyone - we are in this together - zoom is helpful but at sometimes it goes too fast for some students - social distancing and teaching the youngest kids is very difficult

Member Graham -We discussed the district setting expectations - what will and won't work - need for increased technology - a lot of sharing in homes - we need to be clear to provide support and supplement the technology - context of a teaching team - providing clubs etc online for more student interaction.- PTO fundraising online - new way to execute

Dr. Edouard- Vincent - thank you everyone for the rich information - our intention is to address Social Emotional learning (next week's agenda) - important for remote learning - trying to have greater consistency for parents, as well as provide support to parents, make it more predictable. Current scheduling is a challenge for working families. Parents offered to help parents with digital divide -(zoom and google classroom) - nice idea!

Ms. Pinto - One parent - non english speaking, works overnight - twins in 1st grade - same curriculum, but different work - separate clases - doesn't understand how to use google classroom - could this be managed a little better - twins placed in same classroom next year would be a huge help.

Ms. Pierre- Paul - No one in group

Ms.Abuhasan - No one in group

Ms. Reinold - No one in group

Mayor - thank you very much We appreciate you all taking the time
I thank everyone for being here and participating. We have a special budget meeting at 530 PM
- This roundtable is just a start

Member McLaughlin - Don't forget to record the questions in the chat please

Member Ruseau - Our students are not very tech savvy. They are not sure what a web browser is or email, etc.

Dr. Cushing - Please remember for those who still have questions or want to leave a comment, please feel free to do so at info@medford.k12.ma.us. We have also taken photos of the chat feature for our records.

Mayor - Thank you

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Engagement subcommittee birthed this idea. All school committee members wanted to be part of the process - provide a roundtable, inclusive experience - We are very grateful that we all participated - We encourage all of you to join us for the next two Wednesdays as well.

Member Graham - We encourage our students to join with us as well.

Mayor - Motion to adjourn? Motion to adjourn by Member Graham, seconded by Member Ruseau

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - Meeting is adjourned at 5:29 PM